CS 101: Introduction to Computer Science & Algorithms
Fall Semester 2026 - Department of Computer Science
Instructor: Prof. Alan Turing (aturing@university.edu)
Office Hours: Tuesdays & Thursdays 2:00 PM - 4:00 PM, Turing Hall Room 402

Section 1. Course Overview and Prerequisites
This course introduces fundamental algorithmic thinking, data structures, and computational complexity. Students will master recursion, sorting algorithms (MergeSort, QuickSort), graph traversals (BFS, DFS), and basic dynamic programming. Prerequisites: High school mathematics and basic programming literacy.

Section 2. Grading Breakdown and Criteria
Final grades are determined by the following weighted components:
- Programming Assignments (5 total): 30%
- Midterm Examination: 25% (Held in Week 8)
- Comprehensive Final Examination: 35% (Held during exam week)
- Class Attendance & Discussion Participation: 10%
Grading Scale: A: 90-100%, B: 80-89%, C: 70-79%, D: 60-69%, F: below 60%.

CS 101: Course Policies and Schedule

Section 3. Late Submission and Extension Policy
Assignments submitted after the deadline will incur a penalty of 10% per 24-hour period of lateness. Submissions more than 72 hours (3 days) late will receive an automatic grade of 0.
Each student is granted two (2) 'Slip Days' for the semester, which can be applied to any programming assignment without penalty. Medical emergencies require documentation from Student Health Services.

Section 4. Recommended Textbooks and Resources
Required: 'Introduction to Algorithms' by Cormen, Leiserson, Rivest, and Stein (CLRS), 4th Edition.
Optional: 'Algorithms' by Robert Sedgewick and Kevin Wayne.
All assignments must be tested on Python 3.11 before submission.